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1929, Love Is Never Bestial

It now became clear to Bhagat Singh that he would not be left alone by the police. He thought it better to leave the country. In a rare letter to his friend Amar Chand written in 1927, he referred to the police harassment and how ‘I have been in quite a state’ and ‘have constantly been facing a lot of problems’. He explains how ‘finally, the case has been withdrawn’ and refers to his ‘desire to go abroad to pursue my studies’. He is worried about his uncle in exile in America, Ajit Singh, inquiring of Amar Chand that ‘perhaps you may hear something about Sardarji from San Francisco’ and enjoins him, ‘please make an effort to find out about him. At least we will be reassured that he is alive’. What is most revealing about his position at this time of his life, when barely out of his teenage years at twenty, is the feeling of being needlessly harassed and persecuted. Any chance of Bhagat Singh turning away from the path of a revolutionary freedom-fighter would have been lost at this stage. On the contrary, these facts suggest that he was being driven into it by the actions of a repressive state itself. He ends his letter to his friend exasperated and forlorn:

> What else should I write about myself; that I’ve been a target of suspicion needlessly? My mail is being checked. Letters are opened. I wonder why they have begun to regard me with so much suspicion. Anyway, Brother, finally, the truth will surface and prevail.[1]

Such is his harassment that by 19 June 1928 Bhagat Singh is still found to be requesting the superintendent of the CID that he ‘return all my clothes and papers that were taken from my body at the time of my arrest on May 29 1927, and the clothes and books that were sent by my father while I was